THE EXPERTS' VIEW



"India can consider abandoning the existing LoC ceasefire pact and launch surgical strikes on select targets. It could also simultaneously deploy IAF assets as it did in Balakot"

LT GEN. DEEPENDRA SINGH HOODA (RETD)
Former chief, Northern Command, Indian Army



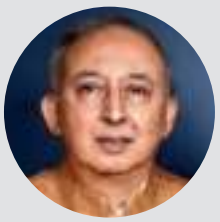
"INDIA COULD GO FOR COVERT OPTIONS, TARGETING HIGH-VALUE FIGURES IN PAKISTAN, INCLUDING TOP LEADERS OF THE JeM AND THE LeT, WHILE ENSURING DENIABILITY"

SHARAT SABHARWAL
Former high commissioner of India to Pakistan

"BY TAKING UP THE KASHMIR CAUSE, GEN. MUNIR WAS HOPING TO STRENGTHEN HIS INTERNAL POSITION BESIDES BOLSTERING THE MULLAH-MILITARY ALLIANCE"

AJAY BISARIA
Former high commissioner of India to Pakistan





"PUBLIC OPINION DEMANDS RETRIBUTION AND ONCE YOU HAVE SET THE BAR SO HIGH AFTER THE URI AND PULWAMA RETALIATIONS, THE MODI GOVT WILL HAVE TO ACT VERY DECISIVELY FOR PEOPLE TO FEEL REASSURED"

TILAK DEVASHER
Author & former RAW officer



LT GEN. SYED ATA HASNAIN (RETD)
Former military secretary, Army HQ

"We must be clear whether we are messaging Pakistan or the world about our capability.... So, it is a question of calibration and what you want to achieve in the end"



"By choosing to suspend the Indus Waters Treaty, India has sent out a powerful message... It is a wrong time geopolitically and otherwise for India to get into a military conflict with Pakistan"

KANWAL SIBAL
Former foreign secretary

in Pahalgam, Pakistan was not only hitting at this economic revival but also letting India, and the world, know that it remained very much a stakeholder in the Valley's future.

But the timing has as much to do with Pakistan's own failings, especially the growing disillusionment with its all-powerful army chief General Asim Munir and his ability to navigate the polycrisis in the country. The daring hijack of the Jaffar Express train by the Baloch Liberation Army (BLA) on March 11, in which 31 people, including 18 armed forces personnel, were killed, was a serious setback for Munir. The Pakistan army has long accused India of actively backing the Baloch rebels and many in the establishment see the Pahalgam attack as a forceful warning from Islamabad asking India not to meddle in its internal affairs. Meanwhile, Pakistan faces mounting pressure on its western front from the Tehrik-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP). A Pashtun movement that wants to overthrow the Pakistan government and form an Islamic emirate, it is backed by the Taliban in Afghanistan. As Sibal notes, "Pakistan created the Taliban in Afghanistan, was gleeful when it returned to power and, now, they are bombing each other. That is a strategic failure of policy."

On the political front, despite being in jail for various charges, Imran Khan continues to be Pakistan's most popular politician. In 2023, supporters of his party, the Pakistan Tehreek-e Insaf (PTI), even stormed the house of the Lahore